

WEEK 13

Past Simple

Read the following text.

Last Summer I **went** to Nice. On the first day, we **ate** in a restaurant with a terrace. It **had** a wonderful view of the sea. The dishes were absolutely delicious. On the second day, we **visited** an art museum. There were many contemporary exhibits there, but I **didn't like** them at all. After visiting the museum, we **returned** to our hotel room as we were really tired. We **didn't do** anything at night. We **spent** the next day at the great beaches of Nice. I **swam** and **sunbathed** all day. It was a short but very entertaining holiday. I definitely want to go to Nice again.

The past simple shows us that an action was in the past, not in the present. We use past tense to talk about a completed action in the past.

EX: Julia Child died in 2004.

We use **verb 2** in positive sentences.

Positive		Negative
Regular past simple verbs have -ed at the end (e.g. called, played, visited). Irregular verbs have a different form, usually with a different vowel sound (e.g. go → went, have → had)		We make the negative with didn't and the infinitive verb.
Regular	We visited an art museum. I sunbathed all day.	I didn't like the exhibits.
Irregular	We ate in a restaurant. It had a wonderful view.	We didn't do anything at night.

The spelling of the simple past form (-ed forms)

Verbs ending in a...			
1. silent e	2. vowel + y	3. consonant + y	4. other forms
close = closed d die = died d phone = phoned	play = played d destroy = destroyed show = showed d	marry = married d carry = carried d study = studied d	visit = visited d miss = missed d watch = watched finish = finished fix = fixed d buzz = buzzed d

Here are the rules:

1. Regular verbs ending in a silent e take /-d/ in the simple past and past participle:
Example:
close=closed**d**
2. Regular verbs ending in a vowel + y take /-ed/ in the simple past and past participle:
Example:
play=played**d**
3. Regular verbs ending in a consonant + y take /-ied/ in the simple past and past participle (the 'y' becomes an 'i' followed by /-ed/)
Example:
marry=married**d**
4. All the other regular verbs take /-ed/ in the simple past and past participle.
Example:
visit=visited**d**

In some verb we double the last letter.

stop – stopped**d**

ban - banned**d**

swap - swapped**d**

Exercises:

A. Fill in the table with the correct verb form.

Present	Past	Present	Past
Hear		Be	
	Left		Put
Swim		Think	
	Drank		Drove
Go		Break	
	Got		Brought
Take		Sit	
	Came		Woke
See		Run	

B. Fill in the blanks below to complete the sentences. Study the boxes above.

1. I (eat)_____ dinner at six o'clock yesterday.
2. They (go)_____ to Italy on their last summer holiday.
3. My neighbor (buy)_____ a new car last week.
4. My family and I (not see) _____ a comedy movie last night. It was a thriller.
5. First, we (do) _____ exercise, and then we (drink) _____ some water.

C. Complete the sentences using the correct form of past simple tense.

1. I _____ (work) in a bank for ten years.
2. He _____ (not / think) that he was right.
3. She _____ (not / study) French at university.
4. He _____ (travel) through the Middle East last year.
5. I _____ (cook) steak last night.

6. She _____ (not / watch) TV yesterday.

7. We _____ (sell) our car last weekend.

D. Complete the sentences with the correct simple past from the verbs given.

1. They _____ (not / meet) yesterday.

2. She _____ (not / write) to her grandmother.

3. We _____ (have) a computer when I was a child.

4. He _____ (try) to lift the box but he couldn't.

5. I _____ (love) ice cream when I was a child.

6. We _____ (not / play) tennis yesterday because it was raining.

IRREGULAR VERB LIST

Verb infinitive	Past simple form
become	became
begin	began
break	broke
bring	brought
build	built
buy	bought
catch	caught
choose	chose
come	came
cost	cost
cut	cut
do	did
draw	drew
drink	drank
drive	drove
eat	ate
fall	fell
feed	fed
feel	felt
fight	fought
find	found
fly	flew
forget	forgot
forgive	forgave
get	got
give	gave
go	went
grow	grew
have	had
hear	heard
hide	hid
hit	hit
hold	held
know	knew
learn	learned
leave	left

Verb infinitive**Past simple form**

lend	lent
lose	lost
make	made
mean	meant
meet	met
pay	paid
put	put
read	read
ride	rode
rise	rose
run	ran
say	said
see	saw
sell	sold
send	sent
set	set
show	showed
sing	sang
sit	sat
sleep	slept
speak	spoke
spend	spent
stand	stood
steal	stole
swim	swam
take	took
teach	taught
tell	told
think	thought
throw	threw
understand	understood
wear	wore
win	won
write	wrote